



GKS GLOBAL
KOREA
SCHOLARSHIP



Ministry of Education
National Institute for
International Education

WB- ROK Schol - ar shi p



Based upon an LOI between WB and ROK Signed In Feb 2025, the ROK government scholarships, Global Korea Scholarship(GKS), were extended to WB's Partner Universities.



To support inclusive and innovative development in Higher education by enhancing inter-university Cooperation and expanding opportunities for students in higher education institutions



Scholarship Program

- Quota: Up to 50 scholars per year

1 YEAR

Korean Language Program



Degree Program



Doctoral degree: 3 years



Master's degree: 2 years

* Scholarship duration varies based on the curriculum or program offered by the University

* Exemptions for the Korean Language Program can be found in the FAQ.

Scholarship

Benefits

	Airfare	Tuition	Korean Language Training Fee	Allowances
Recipient	All Scholars	Scholars in Degree Program	Scholars in Korean Language Program	All Scholars
Benefits	One Round-trip Economy class flight ticket (actual expense)	NIIED and ROK Universities will cover the Tuition	5.2 million KRW (four quarters) paid directly to language institute to cover training fee	- Language Program 14.1 million KRW (about 10,500 USD) per year - Graduate Degree Program 15.7 million KRW (about 11,700 USD) per year

INTERNAL. The allowance amount in USD has been converted using today's exchange rate to assist your understanding, and it may vary depending on the exchange rate.

Programs (Consisting of departments in various fields established **GKS Universities***)

- Provided by departments at Metropolitan (Type A) and regional universities (Type B)
- Various majors such as humanities, social studies, natural sciences, arts and athletics, etc
- Master's or Doctoral program (upon successful completion of language course or exemption)
- Provided by departments at regional universities (Type B)
- Various majors such as humanities, social studies, natural sciences, arts and athletics, etc
- Master's or Doctoral program (upon successful completion of language course or exemption)
- Focused on cutting-edge science and engineering in emerging industries
- 21 Schools (SNU, Yonsei, KAIST, etc) provide programs in R&D
- Master's or Doctoral program (upon successful completion of language course or exemption)
- Focused on humanities and social science departments related to enhancing global cooperation
- 5 Schools (SNU, Yonsei, KDI, PNU, KAIST) provide master's programs in international studies
- Master's program within 2 years (Conducted mainly in English / No Korean language course)

Available Universities

Classification	Available Universities
Type A (33 institutions)	Academy of Korean Studies, Ajou University, Chung-Ang University, Dankook University, Dongguk University, Duksung Women's University, Ewha Womans University, GIST (Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology), Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Hanyang University (ERICA), Hanyang University (Seoul), Hongik University, Incheon National University, Inha University, KAIST (Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology), KDI School of Public Policy and Management, Konkuk University, Kookmin University, Korea University, Kyung Hee University, POSTECH (Pohang University of Science and Technology), Seokyeong University, Seoul National University, SeoulTech (Seoul National University of Science and Technology), Sogang University, Sookmyung Women's University, Soongsil University, Sungkyunkwan University, Sungshin Women's University, Tech University of Korea, UNIST (Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology), University of Seoul, Yonsei University

Available Universities

Classification	Available Universities
Type B (41 institutions)	Busan University of Foreign Studies, Changwon National University, Cheongju University, Chonnam National University, Chosun University, Chungbuk National University, Chungnam National University, Daegu Catholic University, Daegu University, Daejeon University, Dong-A University, Dongseo University, Gangneung-Wonju National University, Gyeongguk National University (Andong National University), Gyeongsang National University, Hannam University, Hoseo University, Inje University, Jeju National University, Jeonbuk National University, Kangwon National University, Keimyung University, Kongju National University, Konyang University, KOREATECH (Korea University of Technology and Education), Kumoh National Institute of Technology, Kunsan National University, Kyungpook National University, Kyungsung University, Mokwon University, National Korea Maritime & Ocean University, Pai Chai University, Pukyong National University, Pusan National University, Semyung University, Silla University, Soonchunhyang University, Sun Moon University, Sunchon National University, University of Ulsan, Yeungnam University

Eligibility

- Students **under 40**
- Current academic professors in one of the ODA recipients **under 45**
- Global Network Program: No age limitations

- Cumulative Grade Point Average(CGPA) of the entire curriculum from the previous (degree) program is **80% or above**

- All applicants must hold **non-Korean citizenship** and IBRD/IDA recipient country listed by the World Bank Group; Dual citizenship with ROK is not allowed.
- Applicant's parents must hold **non-Korean citizenship**
- Academic professors must hold citizenship of the ODA recipient country listed by OECD DAC.

- **Graduate:** Bachelor's or master's degree
 - Applicants who are **expected to graduate by July 31st** can apply for the program
- For this round of WB-ROK Scholarship, students and faculty from the institutions affiliated with the African Centers of Excellence and PASET programs would be recommended to apply

Applicants must check **additional restrictions or eligibility** set by each university.



Select i on Pro- cedur e

Announcement of Applica- tion Guidelines(NIIED) (Early Feb)

Available Programs, Benefits, Required Documents, Main points of Evaluation, FAQs
(www.studyinkorea.go.kr > K-Scholarship > GKS Notice)

Applicants ask for recommendation letter from the WB Partner University (refer to slide 13)

WB Partner University issues recommendation letters to the applicant

Announcement of 1st Round Selection Schedule (Universities, Feb)

Announced by each Korean university

- Each university established its own selection plan and schedule and fee structure (all fees related to applying—university application fees, apostille/consular fees, postage, etc.--are the responsibility of the applicant).

Application Submission (Universities)

Application deadline are set by each university

- Please check the website of each university (Varies from mid-March to end-March, April)

Selection Procedure

1st Round Selection Schedule (Universities)	Result Announcement of the first round of selection - set by each university
Recommend Successful Candidates to NIIED (Universities→NIIED)	Successful candidates' applications and related documents arrive at NIIED - By May 1
2nd Round of Selection (NIIED)	Announcement of successful candidates of the 2 nd round (www.studyinkorea.go.kr > K-Scholarship > GKS Notice) - By early June
Announcement of GKS-G Scholars (NIIED)	The final successful candidates will be announced (www.studyinkorea.go.kr > K-Scholarship > GKS Notice) - Expected announcement date: late June

Required Documents

Type	No.	Application Documents	Master's	Doctoral
Documents to complete (Required)	1	(Form 1) Application Form	Required	Required
	2	(Form 2) Personal Statement	Required	Required
	3	(Form 3) Study Plan	Required	Required
	4	(Form 5) ONE Letter of Recommendation - WB-ROK Scholarship applicants should submit recommendation letter from the WB Partner University (see slide 13)	Required	Required
	5	(Form 7) Korean Language Program Exemption Application - See exemptions criteria at the FAQ	Optional	Optional
	6	(Form 8) GKS Applicant Agreement	Required	Required
	7	(Form 9) Personal Medical Assessment	Required	Required
	8	(Form 10) Consent to Collect and Use Personal Information	Required	Required

Required Docu-

Certificates (Required)	11	Applicant's/Parent(s)' Proof of Citizenship and family relationship Document	Required	Required
	12	Bachelor's Graduation Certificate (or Diploma)	Required	Required
	12'	Bachelor's Degree Transcript	Required	Required
	13	Master's Graduation Certificate (or Diploma)		Required
	13'	Master's Degree Transcript		Required
	15	Certificate of Employment - only applicable for Faculty members from WB Partner universities	Required	Required
	16*	Proof of Overseas Korean Document/Proof of Korean Adoptee Document	Optional	Optional
	17*	Proof of Korean Citizenship Renunciation Document - applicant and his/her parent(s)	Optional	Optional
	18*	Proof of Korean War Veteran's Descendant	Optional	Optional
	19*	Certificate of Employment or certificate of Experience (e.g., faculty members of the International Organization partner university)	Optional	Optional

Must be
Apostilled or
Consular
confirmed

*Required
for relevant
applicants

Required Documents – Letter of Recommendation

All WB-ROK Scholarship applicants should submit one recommendation letter **from the WB Partner University** and attach it as a part of the application package.

- Link to the template : <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1kknlu7cGb1tBi6VrbNoRVm0UT80SPXMC/edit?usp=sharing&ouid=102662323007126816817&rtpof=true&sd=true>

THE WORLD BANK IBRD • IDA • WORLD BANK GROUP		StudyinKorea FOR THE FUTURE LEADERSHIP	
00 March 2025		Attachment 1	
Recommendation Letter for World Bank-Republic of Korea Scholarship (WB-ROK Scholarship) from [University Name]			
To whom it may concern,			
I am delighted to recommend the applicant, [applicant's name], for the WB-ROK Scholarship (Attachment 1). The candidate is an esteemed [choose one: student/graduate/faculty member] of our university and meets all the eligibility criteria specified in Attachment 2. Furthermore, the person has obtained/is scheduled to obtain his/her diplomas from the [XX degree] program no later than July 31, 2025, positioning him/her to begin the scholarship program in the Republic of Korea in September 2025. [The contents should be consistent with the following but may be edited as needed] The academic and professional development of [applicant's name] is of paramount importance to us, as it directly contributes to the ongoing success and impact of our current project with WB. The candidate has consistently demonstrated strong academic performance and dedication to his/her studies, exemplifying the high standards we uphold at our institution. The candidate's commitment to excellence and their aspirations for meaningful contributions to society underscore his/her suitability for this prestigious scholarship. I wholeheartedly endorse [applicant's name] for postgraduate study in the Republic of Korea and am confident in their potential to contribute significantly to our nation's development. They possess the academic excellence, commitment, and ambition that will make them invaluable assets to our country's future growth and progress. If you require any additional information or further insight into this applicant's qualifications and achievements, please feel free to contact me at [email address].			
Sincerely,			
[Your Name] [Your Position] [University Name] [University Address] [Email Address]			

THE WORLD BANK IBRD • IDA • WORLD BANK GROUP		StudyinKorea FOR THE FUTURE LEADERSHIP		
Attachment 2		Attachment 2		
Recommended Applicant				
Name of Applicants (same as the names in their passport)	Nationality	Date of Birth (DD/MM/YY)	Degree Program Applied for Master's / PhD / Global Network Program	Department Applied for Admission, School Applied for Admission The Name of Department The Name of University
Mr./Ms. _____				

THE WORLD BANK IBRD • IDA • WORLD BANK GROUP		StudyinKorea FOR THE FUTURE LEADERSHIP	
Attachment 2		Attachment 2	
Eligibility Criteria			
The following criteria are the minimum requirements for the scholarship. Applicants should check any additional requirements set by each Korean university.			
- Applicants for scholarships for Master's degree programs must possess a Bachelor's degree, and applicants for scholarships for Doctoral studies programs must possess a Master's degree. - All applicants must hold citizenship of IBRD and IDA recipient countries of WB¹. Applicants' parents (or legal guardians) must hold citizenship from another country other than ROK. - Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of the entire curriculum from the previous degree program² must meet one of the conditions as follows: (i) score percentile should be 80% or above on a 100-point scale or be ranked in the top 20% of one's class, (ii) CGPA must be equal to or above 2.64/4.0, 2.80/4.3, 2.91/4.5, or 3.23/5.0. - All applicants must be in good health, both mentally and physically, to study in ROK for the full duration of the program. - Applicants must be under 40 years of age (born after September 1, 1985). Academic professors³ under 40 years of age are eligible to apply. No age limitations with Global Network Program⁴ applicants.			

¹ Please check <https://datahelpdesk1.worldbank.org/knowledgebase/articles/505618-world-bank-country-and-lending-groups> and <https://data.worldbank.org/about/borrowing-countries>

² For example, previous degree for a doctoral degree program applicant is a master's degree program.

³ According to ROK's national ODA policy, academic professors must hold the nationality of a country listed as an ODA recipient by the OECD DAC.

⁴ Global Network Program is available for master's degrees in international studies only at 5 schools: KDI school, Busan National University, Seoul National University, Yonsei University and KAIST. Further details will be announced on the official website: <http://www.studyinkorea.go.kr>

Required Documents

All documents must be submitted in English or Korean

- Documents written in English or Korean must be **apostilled or consular confirmed**.
- Documents written in other languages:
 - 1) must be submitted together with a certified translation in English or Korean,
 - 2) must be apostilled or consular confirmed (either original document or certified translation)

Applicants submit one set of apostilled/consular confirmed documents directly to the University they're applying to.

Official announcement is on the website:

<http://studyinkorea.go.kr> > K-Scholarship >



- WB-ROK follows general official guidelines of the applications. However, WB-ROK Scholarship specific information can be updated at the end-Feb / early March



K-Scholarship

Please enter your search term.



Home > K-Scholarship > GKS Notice

GKS Notice

All



Please enter your search term.

Search

There are a total of 333 search results

No.	Title	Writer	Date	Count
4272	2025 ADB-ROK Scholarship Guidelines	GKS Center	2025-02-06	17444
4269	2025 Application Guidelines of Global Korea Scholarship for Graduate Degrees(GKS-G) / 2025학년도 정부초청외국인 대학원 장학생 모집 요강	GKS Center	2025-01-24	229423
4268	[2025 Global Korea Scholarship Korea-Japan Undergraduate/Graduate Degree Program Final Result Announcement / 2025년 GKS 한일교육교류협력사업 전문학사·학사/석·박사 장학생 최종합격자 ...	GKS center	2025-01-20	18928
4265	2025 GKS-U Final Result Announcement / 2025 정부초청외국인 학부 프로그램 최종 합격자 명단 발표	GKS Center	2025-01-10	23663
4261	2025 한일 공동 고등교육 유학생 교류사업 학부 1년 과정 합격자 공고(Final Result Announcement for 2025 Korea-Japan Government Scholarship for 1 year Undergraduate Program)	webmaster	2024-12-27	11946
4260	2025 한일 공동 고등교육 유학생 교류사업 학부1년과정 장학생 선발결과 발표 연기 안내/ 2025 韓日共同高等教育留学生交流事業の学部一年課程の奨学生応募結果の発表延期のご案内	webmaster	2024-12-19	8236
4259	[University Track-2nd Round Result] 2025 GKS Undergraduate Degree Program	GKS Center	2024-12-17	17686



2025 Global Korea Scholarship
Application Guidelines for Graduate Degrees

2025. 1.



This application guideline was originally written in Korean and translated to English. The Korean application guideline prevails the translated application guideline if any conflicts occur in the interpretation.

For applicants,

- **Reading the official Application Guidelines is the most important step.**

Information Session

For more information, please register for an information session at
8am Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) (= 5pm in Korea)
on **Friday, March 7, 2025**

Please register in advance to attend the meeting on Zoom

**[https://renu.zoom.us/meeting/register/UTSAchrrRD-
m0u64FW8QbEQ](https://renu.zoom.us/meeting/register/UTSAchrrRD-m0u64FW8QbEQ)**

Contact Information

<https://www.studyinkorea.go.kr>
(K-Scholarship – GKS Notice)

Inquiries regarding requirements/documents/eligibility:
gksnied@korea.kr

Inquiries regarding WB-ROK Scholarship – recommendation letter & procedure:
gkim3@worldbank.org

FAQs: Application Procedure

- **Can the applicant apply to multiple universities?**
 - Applicants can only apply to one university and one department. If an applicant is found to have applied to more than two universities, their scholarship will be cancelled.
- **When is the deadline for the application?**
 - Each University has a different application period. Please check the website of each university.
- **May the applicant submit their application to WB?**
 - No. Applicants must submit their application documents directly to the university they are applying. Submission to WB or KMOE/NIIED will not be accepted. Any documents mistakenly sent to WB/KMOE/NIIED will be excluded from the screening and will not be returned.

FAQs: Application Procedure

- **I'm expected to graduate from my current degree program in May of 2025. Am I eligible to apply for this program?**
 - **Yes. Applicants who are expected to graduate by July 31st, 2025 can also apply for the program with a certificate of expected graduation. Such applicants must submit their official graduation certificate (or diploma) and final academic transcript to GKS Center, NIIED by July 31st, 2025. Failure to do so will result in the cancellation of your acceptance.**
- **I have a master's degree. Can I apply for a master's degree program in a different major? Which degree certificate should I submit?**
 - **You can apply for a master's program while holding another master's degree. If you are applying to a master's degree program, you should submit a degree certificate and academic transcript of your bachelor's degree. In this case, your CGPA of your bachelor's degree should meet the grade requirement in the application guidelines. Providing your master's degree certificate and academic transcript is optional.**

FAQs: Application Procedure

- **I am applying for a doctoral degree program. Should I also submit a CGPA of my bachelor's degree?**
 - **Applicants for a doctoral degree program should put a CGPA of their previous degree (master's degree) on the application form. Doctoral degree program applicants should submit the graduation certificate and official academic transcript of both bachelor's and master's degree. The CGPA required in the application is of the master's degree.**
- **When it comes to faculty members, is this opportunity open only to those who are currently employed?**
 - **Yes, if you are applying as a faculty member, you must currently be a faculty member (former faculty are not eligible in this case). If you are a current academic professor with citizenship from one of the ODA recipient countries and are under 45, you are eligible to apply as a faculty member.**
 - **All general students and graduates under the age of 40 and affiliated with a university engaged in a World Bank program activity are eligible to apply for the WB-ROK Scholarship.**

FAQs: Language course

- **Is it mandatory for all GKS scholars to pass at least Level 3 in TOPIK after one year of Korean Language Program?**
 - **Yes. Every GKS scholar (except scholars in Global Network program) must achieve at least Level 3 on TOPIK (Test of Proficiency in Korean) within a yearlong Korean language program to proceed to his or her degree program.**
 - **In addition, certain university or department requires students to submit a valid TOPIK certificate of level 4 or higher. Scholars who applied to such department may not enter their degree program if they fail to achieve the required TOPIK certificate during a yearlong Korean language program.**

FAQs: Language course

- **The degree program I applied to is taught in English only. May I be exempt from the Korean Language Program?**
 - **No. A yearlong Korean language program is an important part of the GKS program. (exception: Global Network Program)**
 - **However, if you have already attained advanced level (Level 5 or 6) on TOPIK when applying for the program, you must submit your valid TOPIK certificate to be exempt from Korean language program. You will directly start your degree program from September 2025.**
 - **If you attain TOPIK level 5 or 6 during the first 6 months of Korean language program, you will be exempt from the remaining 6-month language program, and you must start your degree program in the following semester (March, 2026).**
 - **Current academic professors who are apply for an exemption from Korean language training in a 100% English-taught program will be exempted from the Korean Language program.**

FAQs: Required document

- **Whom should the applicant get a recommendation letter from?**
 - **WB-ROK Scholarship applicant should get a recommendation letter from the WB Partner university.**
- **For the legalization on “Required certificates”, can I choose between apostille or consular confirmation?**
 - **Countries that have joined the Apostille Convention, can only issue an apostille. For the rest of the countries, you should obtain consular confirmation from the Korean embassy/consulate in your country.**
 - **If your country does not belong to the Apostille Convention or if the document cannot be apostilled, please obtain a consular confirmation from the Korean embassy/consulate.**

FAQs:

Others

- **May I change my final university choice during my Korean language program or during a degree program?**
 - **No. Changing the university or transferring to another university is NOT PERMITTED.**

THANK YOU



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